

Decent music quality and a gorgeous screen (its highlight, really) will be yours for the taking.

The Motomob loses out on functionality. It's definitely not for serious business users; rather, it targets those in between a fully-functional PDA and something flashy. The Motomob is only for Motorola fans who want a touchscreen real cheap...

Nokia's E61 / E62 duo have very good build quality, great screens, and functional QWERTY keypads to their credit. The E61 bags the Digit Best Buy Silver award, and shadows its cheaper twin by a hairsbreadth with the inclusion of Wi-Fi—which in our collective opinion is a must for this type of device. If you need wireless connectivity, this is the sub-17,000 smartphone to buy. If you don't, the E62 will suffice. Being a newer model, the E62 has support for A2DP, something the E61 misses out on.

For someone looking at the flexibility and application support provided by Windows Mobile, look no further than the HP iPAQ 514 at this price point. It has all the basic tools to get your job done, Wi-Fi support, MS Office support, and a host of useful applications pre-installed. At Rs 14,000, this is the cheapest way to go WM!

Finally, we have our Digit Best Buy Gold winner—Nokia's E50 was just too irresistible a package to deny it the award. A PDA it's not, but it's got nearly all the goodies except for wireless connectivity. The inclusion of a camera certainly doesn't hurt. Just right for the executive—who wants something that looks classy, is compact, and has all the necessary features for a business-oriented device, with some multimedia capabilities thrown in.

Beyond The Basics

(From Rs 17,001 To Rs 25,000)

Features

This category is where the fun really starts, as each manufacturer now has a sizeable budget to work with to give even more functionality, and more importantly, *usability*. That word was missing in the sub-17,000 phones. What's the use of all the features in the world when they aren't usable... for example, a PDA that allows you to write MS Word documents, but doesn't give you a proper keypad to accomplish the task. As many

Blackberry's Pearl features a compact yet functional QWERTY keypad and a roller-ball-type joypad that makes navigation a snap

BEST BUY
digit
AUGUST 2007



Sony Ericsson P990i
Features galore

users will testify to, working with T9 predictive text is a pain for anything longer than 30 words.

HTC's Touch was something to look at. Based around the iPhone-like TouchFLO navigation, this is one smart-looking phone. It's well-finished in velvet black, which gives it a soft feel. The navigation button on the front bezel looks amazingly attractive—large and white set in a chrome bezel. TouchFLO tries to cash in on the iPhone concept of using your finger to swipe around the screen, and it works pretty well on this phone. For example, swiping your finger on the HTC logo grants access to multimedia (music, photo, and video) content. The swipe also works well for contacts—swipe left for previous and right for next, and so on. The swipe motion needs you to exert a little extra pressure, which most users will have to adjust to.

HTC's D600 is a budget attempt at a PDA—but a good one. It's got an excellent screen, in fact, even better than that on the C800 (another costlier HTC model); it looks clearer. The buttons are also very well-placed on the front bezel—a good thing, considering it lacks a keypad.

The **HTC C720W** has a full QWERTY keypad, a little too much chrome on the front bezel, and a really nifty and functional set of touch keys on the front bezel that control volume with a finger-flick. The keypad compromises on spacing for compactness, and the keys are hard—but once again, it's quite usable.

The **O2 Xda Stealth** is the fourth WM device in this category. Rounded corners and black make for a good combination, and this phone features one of the best sliders around—smooth as butter, with just the right feedback even after a couple of weeks of use. The positioning of the stylus underneath the phone and too close to the USB port is quite an irritation.

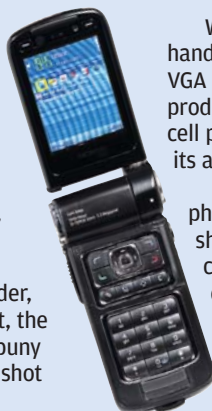
One of the only devices with both number and QWERTY keypads, **Sony Ericsson's P990i** is a large phone, with a large and crisp screen. The iffy materials used on its exterior didn't leave a good impression. While the backlighting is excellent, the QWERTY is not ergonomic—the buttons are too small, and it takes some getting used to. The number keypad looks uncomfortable but is surprisingly easy on the fingers. This phone also has a good camera

Nokia N93—Look Ma, I'm A Camcorder!

Nokia's N93 is a camcorder under the guise of a fully-functional cell phone. It's a clamshell phone that, once open, allows you to twist the screen, thereby orienting it for viewing while shooting. Incidentally, the camera is mounted on the side of the phone. This gives a handycam-type of feel while shooting.

The keypad is very well-laid-out: great key spacing, and good feedback and tactility. Even the joypad feels good under your thumb.

It's bulky at 180 grams, but not bulky for a camcorder, we say. With Wireless, 3G, EDGE, and Bluetooth support, the N93 is really connected. We were dissatisfied with the puny 128 MB memory card bundled, although the videos we shot turned out to be surprisingly compact.



While it's fairly middling at photo shooting (the N73ME beats it hands down), video shooting is what Nokia has been harping about. VGA resolution (640 x 480) at 30 fps is good, and capable of producing some nice, clear videos. With 3x optical zoom (the only cell phone with this feature!), the N93 makes no bones about where its appeal lies. Good-quality MP3 playback, too, is a definite plus.

At Rs 42,209, the Nokia N93 is definitely costly, but it's a phone that has no competition really when it comes to video shooting. It's as close as cell phones have come to digital camcorders, but to be honest, to that section of consumer electronics the gap is more a chasm at the moment. We hope to see bigger and better sensors, higher video resolutions, and a longer optical zoom on Nokia's camcorder range in the future. If you aren't into video shooting, give the N93 a miss—other cell phones will do all it does at half the price!